

Up and away
Hovercraft are also known as air-cushion vehicles because they float on a cushion of air.



When the hovercraft is sitting still on the tarmac, the skirt is flat and empty.



The engines start, and the skirt fills with air to become a thick cushion.



Hovering just above the surface of the water, the vehicle speeds on its way.

Military vehicles or cars drive in through the doors in the back.

Propellers push the vehicle forward.

Inflatable skirt



Thin fins

Fins under a hydrofoil lift it out of the water so that it can skim over the surface at great speed.



Riding high

Catamarans have two thin hulls so there is very little of the boat in the water to slow it down.

Super speedy

Superboats have very powerful engines. They race at speeds of around 155 miles (250 kilometers) an hour—so fast that their hulls rise right out of the water.

